INTRODUCTORY SOMMELIER COURSE AND EXAM

AND

CERTIFIED SOMMELIER THEORY EXAM

CURRICULUM GUIDE

INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: FRANCE - BORDEAUX

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier
Wine Law / Classification / Producers	**A Introductory Sommelier Course student should be able to recognize the name and label of the following châteaux and identify them as being from the Bordeaux region of France.** Château Lafite Rothschild (Pauillac) Château Latour (Pauillac) Château Mouton Rothschild (Pauillac) Château Margaux (Margaux) Château Haut-Brion (Graves) Château d'Yquem (Sauternes) Château Petrus (Pomerol) Château Ausone (St-Émilion) Château Cheval- Blanc (St-Émilion)	**A Certified Sommelier should be able to recognize the name and label of these châteaux, know the wine-style produced, and identify it the region in Bordeaux it is made.** **1855 Classification** First Growths: (château and commune) (5) Second Growths: (château and commune) (14) **Graves Top Producer:** Château Haut Brion **Sauternes Top Producer:** Château d'Yquem **Pomerol Top Producers:** (5) Château Pétrus Château Lafleur Le Pin Clos l'Eglise **St-Émilion top Producers** (5) Château Angélus Château Ausone Château Cheval-Blanc Château Pavie Château Figeac
Label Terms		
General Terms	Barrique Château	
Vintage	Every vintage is very different. Yearly weather affects the wine style and the selling price.	Understand the connection between yearly weather/vintage variation/wine style/and wine selling price ***Know the top vintages of the last 15 years and understand why they are top vintages.**
History & Lore	Marriage of Eleanor of Aquitaine Dutch innovation and exportation Slave trade port Today: largest region of AOP wine production in France Global image, evolution of market and style.	Deeper knowledge of the history of Bordeaux to gain a better understanding of the region as it is today. Marriage of Eleanor of Aquitaine The Dutch draining of the Gironde Estuary Slave trade port Today: largest region of AOP wine production in France. Global image evolution of market and style. Highly regarded ratings. How has the perception of Bordeaux changed?
Service of Beverage		Decanting young Bordeaux for aeration, decanting aged Bordeaux for sediment. Service temperatures.
Food and Beverage Pairing	Bold red wines with beef and lamb, rich sweet wines with dessert and foie gras.	Know important classic pairings with the various styles of Bordeaux and why they pair well.
Business of the Sommelier		Understanding Bordeaux vintages and styles to understand price differences, appropriate purchasing and recommendations tableside in a restaurant.

INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: FRANCE - BURGUNDY

Learning Outcome Introductory Sommelier Course: After studying this section, a student will be able to identify Burgundy and the five major regions within Burgundy on a map. Students will learn the history that influences the region, prominent soil types, the classification hierarchy, and grape varieties associated with each area. Students should be able to recognize major villages and highlighted significant vineyards within the Côte d'Or.

Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam: After studying this section, a candidate will be able to identify major villages, grand crus, soil types, and winemaking styles for each area of Burgundy. A Certified Sommeliers will recognize iconic producers and be able to recommend and sell food pairings with the various wines from Burgundy to a guest.

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Geography: Location	Set of five non-contiguous regions in eastern France.	
Geography: Climate Category	Cool Continental	
Geography: Physical Features	Hills, aspect and slope of vineyards	How do the hills, aspect. and slopes affect ripening potential of a vineyard site.
Wine: White Grape Variety Names	Chardonnay, Aligoté (in small amounts) ***Connect the Chardonnay grape variety with the major regions and appellations mentioned above.**	
Wine: Red Grape Variety Names	Pinot Noir, Gamay ***Connect both of these grape varieties with major regions and appellations mentioned above**	
Soil: Type and/or Name	**Chablis and Côte d'Or:** Limestone, clay **Beaujolais**: Granite	Kimmeridgian, Portlandian, marl, schist, chalk, limestone
Grape Growing		Frost hazard in Chablis Distinction in style between Chardonnay and Pinot Noir in Chablis, Côte d'Or, and Chalonnaise as a consequence of geography. Benefits/consequences of planting density. Oidium and Mildew. General effects of limestone soils on vine vigor.
Winemaking	Malolactic fermentation Carbonic maceration Use of new French Oak	Bâttonage Cold soak/prefermentation maceration Stem inclusion, whole cluster fermentation, semi-carbonic maceration. Piéce barrel size. Chaptalization. Variations in oak usage between Grand Cru/Premier/Village in Chablis. Variations in oak usage in Mâconnais (Mâcon-Villages vs. Pouilly-Fuissé). Variations in oak usage between Beaujolais Nouveau/Villages/Cru.
Style	Dry white wines Dry red wines	Major sources for Crémant sparkling wines made in the traditional method.

INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: FRANCE - BURGUNDY

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier
Wine Law / Appellations	**Recognize the regions of Burgundy on a map:** 1. Chablis 2. Côte d'Or - Côte de Nuits - Côte de Beaune 3. Côte Chalonnaise 4. Mâconnais 5. Beaujolais	
Wine Law / Appellations / Classification	Regional AOP / Villages AOP / Premier Cru AOP / Grand Cru AOP	
Wine Law / Appellation/ Classification	**Regional AOP: Bourgogne AOP** **Chablis AOP:** Village / Premier Cru / Grand Cru AOPs * Recognize the Chablis Grand Cru **Les Clos AOP**. **Côte d'Or:** Consist of two Regional AOPs: Côte de Nuits and Côte de Beaune. Each has Village / Premier Cru / Grand Cru AOPs ***<u>Recognize</u> selected Villages of the Côte de Beaune and the Côte de Nuits.** **Côte de Nuits Village AOPs:** Gevrey-Chambertin AOP, Morey-St.-Denis AOP, Chambolle-Musigny AOP, Vougeot AOP, Vosne-Romanée AOP, and Nuits-St.-Georges AOP **Côte de Beaune Village AOPs:** Pommard AOP, Volnay AOP, Meursault AOP, Chassagne-Montrachet AOP, Puligny-Montrachet AOP **Beaujolais AOP:** Beaujolais-Villages / Beaujolais Cru * Recognize the Beaujolais Cru **Morgon AOP**.	**Chablis:** Chablis AOP vs. Petit Chablis AOP. Know the names of all Chablis Grands Crus (7) and recognize Important Chablis Premier Crus. **Côte d'Or** Côte de Nuits-Villages AOP Côte de Beaune-Villages AOP **Côte de Nuits:** Know all villages and the Grand Cru vineyards (if applicable) in each village. **Côte de Beaune:** Know all villages and the Grand Cru vineyards (if applicable) in each village. **Beaujolais:** Identification of the 10 Beaujolais Crus. Recognize the lieu-dit Côte du Py in Morgon. **Côte Chalonnaise:** Bouzeron AOP: white wines from 100% Aligoté Rully AOP, Mercurey AOP, Givry AOP, Montagny AOP **Mâcon AOP:** Pouilly-Fuissé AOP has Premier Cru designated vineyards.

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Subject Name: FRANCE - BURGUNDY

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier
Label Terms	Négociant Domaine Clos Monopole Vieilles Vignes	
General Terms		Lieu dit / lieux dits
Producers/Proprietary Brand		Distinguish major Négociants from Domaines. **Chablis:** Dauvissat, Raveneau **Côte d'Or:** DRC, Leroy, Coche-Dury, Domaine Leflaive, Roulot **Larger Négociants:** Louis Jadot, Louis Latour, Albert Bichot, Bouchard Père et Fils/William Fèvre, Drouhin, Faiveley
Vintage		Know general quality levels of vintages in the past 10 years.
History & Lore	The Monastic and Napoleonic Code of Inheritance influences on classification, fragmentation of vineyards, and vineyard ownership.	
Non-Wine Production		Marc de Bourgogne
Service of Beverage		Proper glassware for white and red Burgundy.
Food and Beverage Pairing		Recognize importance of oak use, acid, and tannin levels for successful food and beverage pairings. Classic Burgundian dishes with the wines of Burgundy.

INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: FRANCE - LOIRE VALLEY

Learning Outcome Introductory Sommelier Course: After studying this section, a student will be able to identify the Loire Valley and selected regions and appellations on a map. Students will be able to connect primary grape varieties to their appellations.

Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam: After studying this section, a candidate will know the major regions and selected appellations of the Loire Valley and be able to connect the grape varieties to their appellations. Candidates will be able to recommend and sell food pairings with Loire Valley wines. Certified Sommeliers will recognize iconic producers and be able to recommend and sell food pairings with wines from the Loire Valley to a guest.

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Geography: Location	Spans from the Atlantic Coast to Central France	
Geography:	**Four Regions of the Loire Valley from West to East:** Pays Nantais Anjou-Saumur Touraine Central Vineyards	
Geography: Physical Feature	The Loire river is the longest river in France beginning in the center of France in the Massif Central.	Layon River
Geography: Climate Categories	**Pays Nantais:** Cool and wet Maritime **Anjou-Saumur:** Maritime moving toward Continental, humid **Touraine:** Continental **Central Vineyards:** Continental	
Geography: Appellations	**Pays Nantais:** Muscadet AOP, Muscadet de Sèvre-et-Maine AOP **Anjou-Saumur:** Saumur AOP, Saumur-Champigny AOP, Savennières AOP, Quarts-de-Chaume AOP, Bonnezeaux AOP **Touraine:** Chinon AOP, Bourgueil AOP, Vouvray AOP **Central Vineyards:** Sancerre AOP, Pouilly-Fumé AOP	
Soil: Type and/or Name	Tuffeau in Vouvray	Silex, Kimmeridgian Clay
Grape Growing	Presence of botrytis in Bonnezeaux AOP and Quarts-de-Chaume AOP due to humidity from multiple rivers.	
Winemaking	**Muscadet:** Sur lie aging **Saumur:** Traditional method sparkling wines, dry white wines, dry red wines, lusciously sweet wines **Touraine:** Vouvray can be sparkling, dry, off-dry and sweet in style.	**Sparkling Wines:** Vouvray Pétillant, Crémant de Loire
Wine: Grape Variety Names	**Muscadet**: Melon B (formerly called Melon de Bourgogne) **Anjou-Saumur:** Chenin Blanc, Cabernet Franc **Touraine:** Chenin Blanc, Cabernet Franc **Central Vineyards:** Sauvignon Blanc, Pinot Noir	

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Subject Name: FRANCE - LOIRE VALLEY

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Wine Law		
Label Terms	Sur lie, Sec, Demi-Sec	Moelleux
General Terms		
Style		
Classification		
Producers/Proprietary Brand		Domaine Huet, Nicolas Joly
History & Lore		Nicolas Joly
Service of Beverage		
Food and Beverage Pairing		Pairings with the different sweetness levels of Chenin Blanc. Classic pairings with Sancerre and Pouilly-Fumé
BOS		

INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: FRANCE - THE RHÔNE VALLEY

Learning Outcome Introductory Sommelier Course: After studying this section, a student will be able to identify the Rhône Valley on a map. A student will know the climatic differences between the Northern and Southern parts of the region, the primary grape varieties, and understand the importance of the Mistral wind and the Rhône River. Students will be able to associate the most important AOCs and Crus with their grape varieties and know a classification system exists in the Southern Rhône. Students will have the ability to describe the major characteristics of a typical Northern Rhône Syrah and a typical Southern Rhône blend. Students will know the major soil types of the Northern Rhône and the famous soil type of the Southern Rhône.

Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam: After studying this section, a candidate will be able to identify the primary and secondary AOCs and Crus, know their locations, primary grape varieties, and general style. Candidates will understand and connect differences in quality and price among AOPs/Crus to physical features and landscape. Certified Sommeliers will recognize iconic producers and be able to recommend and sell food pairings with wines from the Rhône Valley to a guest.

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Geography: Location	Between Burgundy and Provence. There is a 30-mile gap between the Northern Rhône and Southern Rhône sections.	Lyon to the north. Montélimar is the unofficial dividing line between the two regions. Avignon is the main city of the south.
Geography: Climate Categories	**Northern Rhône:** Moderate Continental **Southern Rhône:** Mediterranean	
Geography: Physical Feature	The Rhône river originates in Switzerland, flows south through France to the Mediterranean Sea. **Northern Rhône:** Steep hillsides **Southern Rhône:** Flatter terrain	Topography of north versus south. **Northern Rhône**: Steep hills, the Rhône River reflects light and provides more exposure. It also concentrates the effects of Mistral. **Southern Rhône:** Rolling hills, the Rhône River provides cooling impact and less slope. **Consideration of slope and aspect on each appellation.**
Soil: Type and/or Name	**Northern Rhône**: Decomposed granite, schist **Southern Rhône:** **Galets**, alluvial, limestone	
Grape Growing	**Northern Rhône**: Terraced slopes with staked vines to reinforce from Mistral wind. **Southern Rhône:** Traditionally bush vines to conserve water and provide shade from the sun.	Modern plantings in the south are often trellised and often dictated by economics.
Winemaking	**Northern Rhône:** Co-fermented wines in the north. **Southern Rhône:** Blended wines in the south.	Cause and effect of co-fermentation. Why wines are blended in the South which includes a deeper dive into Grenache and its strengths and weaknesses.
Wine: White Grape Variety Names	**Northern Rhône:** Viognier, Marsanne, Roussanne, **Southern Rhône:** Grenache Blanc	**Southern Rhône:** Bourboulenc, Clairette Blanche, Picpoul
Wine: Red Grape Variety Names	**Northern Rhône:** Syrah, **Southern Rhône:** Grenache, Mourvèdre	**Southern Rhône:** Cinsault

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Subject Name: FRANCE - THE RHÔNE VALLEY

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Wine Law / Appellations / Classification	**Northern Rhône AOPs:** - Côte Rôtie AOP - Crozes-Hermitage AOP - Hermitage AOP - St.-Joseph AOP - Condrieu AOP - Cornas AOP **Note the styles of wine made in each AOP* **Southern Rhône:** Classification tiers **- Côtes-du-Rhône AOP** **- Côtes-du-Rhône Villages AOP** (named villages) **- Crus/Single Village** *Examples:* - Châteauneuf-du-Pape AOP - Tavel AOP - Gigondas AOP - Vacqueyras AOP - Muscat de Beaumes-de-Venise AOP **Note the **primary** grape varieties and the **primary** style of wine made in each AOP*	**Northern Rhône:** - Château Grillet AOP - Which grape varieties are permitted in each Northern Rhône AOP? **Southern Rhône:** - Learn examples of Côtes-du-Rhône Villages - Understand the elevation differences between Côtes-du-Rhône, Côtes-du-Rhône Villages, Cru AOP (single villages).
Wine Law		Minimum abv. in Châteauneuf-du-Pape Minimum Grenache requirements of Southern Rhône AOPs.
Label Terms	**Vins Doux Naturels** *example* Muscat de Beaumes-de-Venise	Other examples of Vins Doux Naturels
General Terms	**Cru** *single village* **Co-fermentation** *which northern Rhône AOP uses co-fermentation?*	
Style	Spicy, meaty reds; rich, aromatic whites	**Muscat de Beaumes-de-Venise:** lightly fortified, unoaked
Producers		Chave, Chapoutier, Guigal, Beaucastel, Rayas
Vintage		
History & Lore	Papal occupation	Papal crest on bottles
Service of Beverage		Glassware choice for Syrah and Grenache.
Food and Beverage Pairing		Pair Rhône wines with meaty dishes involving herbs, bacon, peppercorn. Choose appropriate weights, intensity (i.e., Côtes-du-Rhône vs Châteauneuf-du-Pape). White Rhône wines can be a Chardonnay alternative.

INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: FRANCE - CHAMPAGNE

Learning Outcome Introductory Sommelier Course: After studying this section, a student will be able to identify Champagne as a region in France on a map, know the grape varieties that make up Champagne, define the points that make Champagne unique from other sparkling wines by understanding the Champagne Method.

Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam: After studying this section, a candidate will know all the steps in the traditional method, the major regions of Champagne, and their major styles. A Certified Sommelier will and be able to speak knowledgeably about vintages over the last 10 years, recognize iconic producers, and be able to recommend and sell food pairings with wines from Champagne to a guest.

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Geography: Location	49th parallel, one of the most northerly wine growing regions.	
Geography: Climate Categories	Cool continental	
Geography: Physical Feature	No protection from Atlantic influence; therefore, unpredictable weather, rain, frost, and hail threats.	Grande Montagne Marne River
Soil: Type and/or Name	Limestone, chalk	
Grape Growing	Grapes are picked earlier to preserve natural acidity.	
Winemaking	**Champagne Method Steps:** Still wine is made Assemblage of *cuvée* Bubbles are created using *liqueur de tirage* Sur lie aging - Autolysis Riddling *(rémuage)* using pupitre or gyropalette Disgorging *(dégorgement)* Dosage added using *liqueur d'expédition*	**Champagne Method:** The contents of liqueur de tirage. The contents of and liqueur d'expédition and how it affects the style of the wine.
Wine: White Grape Variety Names	Chardonnay	30% Chardonnay for plantings
Wine: Red Grape Variety Names	Pinot Noir, Meunier	38% Pinot Noir, 32% Meunier for plantings.
Wine Law / Appellations: AOP	**Region:** Champagne AOP **Subregions:** Vallée de la Marne, Côte des Blancs, Montagne de Reims	Côte des Bar Côte de Sézanne
Wine Law / Classification	**Non-Vintage:** 12 month on lees, min 15 months total aging. **Vintage:** min 36 months total aging.	**Échelle des Crus:** Grand Cru Villages and Premier Cru Villages exist and may be put on labels. **Comité Interprofessionnel du Vin de Champagne**

INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: FRANCE - CHAMPAGNE

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier
Label Terms	Blanc de Blancs Blanc de Noirs Brut	Special Club Récoltant Manipulant Négociant Manipulant Vieilles Vignes
General Terms	Cuvée de Prestige/Tête de Cuvée Négociant Grower	Grandes Marques
Style	Brut, Non-Vintage, Vintage, Blanc de Blancs, Blanc de Noirs, Rosé	Single vineyard Clos **Sweetness levels:** Brut Nature, Extra Brut, Brut, Extra Dry, Sec, Demi-Sec, Doux
Producer/Proprietary Brand	Moët & Chandon, Roederer, Veuve Clicquot, Taittinger, Charles Heidsieck, Krug	Be able to match **Grandes Marques** to their prestige cuvées. Know three non-Grandes Marques producers and three grower producers.
Vintage		Know the best vintages going back 15 years.
History & Lore	Invention of riddling rack (Madame Clicquot) and gyropalette.	
Service of Beverage	Never point the cork at someone while opening the bottle and never take your hand off the top (the cage and cork) top while removing the cork.	CMS-A published sparkling wine opening standards.
Food and Beverage Pairing		Champagne is an incredibly versatile beverage that goes with many types of foods.
BOS		

INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: FRANCE - ALSACE

Learning Outcome Introductory Sommelier Course: After studying this section, a student will be able to recognize and locate Alsace as a region in France on a map, identify its main grape varieties, and understand how its geography and history affect the styles of wine made.

Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam: After studying this section, a candidate will understand the classification of Alsatian wine and be able to identify important Grands Crus vineyard names. A Certified Sommelier will be able to recognize iconic producers and be able to recommend and sell food pairings with wines from Alsace to a guest.

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Geography: Location	Northeastern France, on the border with Germany.	Divided into two departments: **Bas-Rhin:** Lies to the north, has a lower in average elevation and is less protected from the Vosges Mountains. **Haut-Rhin:** Lies to the south, has a higher average elevation, and is more protected from the Vosges Mountains. Many of the best regarded vineyard sites are located in the Haut-Rhin.
Geography: Climate Categories	Cool, continental climate with a dry, sunny growing season.	
Geography: Physical Features	Vosges Mountains Rhine River	
Soil: Type and/or Name	Soils vary widely in their type and origin as a result of a long history of geological activity.	Very diverse and includes: Marl, limestone, gneiss, schist, sandstone, granite, clay, and volcanic soils. Grape varieties are matched with the soil types they do best in.
	The importance of the Vosges mountains in creating a rain shadow that affects vineyards. One of France's driest and sunniest climates. Long, cool, and dry growing season. Better vineyards planted on slopes facing east/southeast. Over 90% of Alsace wines are made from white grape varieties.	
Winemaking	Large neutral casks, little to no use of new oak. Sparkling, dry, off-dry, and sweet wines are made.	**Foudre:** name for the large neutral casks used.
Wine: White Grape Variety Names	Riesling, Gewurztraminer, Pinot Gris, Muscat	Pinot Blanc, Silvaner, Chardonnay, Auxerrois
Wine: Red Grape Variety Names	Pinot Noir	

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Subject Name: FRANCE - ALSACE

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier
Wine Law / Appellations: AOPs	Must be 100% of the grape variety if the name is mentioned on the label.	Alsace AOP wines must be bottled in the traditional **"Vin du Rhin" / "Flûte d'Alsace"** bottle.
	Alsace/Vin d'Alsace AOP: Main appellation of Alsace **Alsace Grand Cru AOP:** 51 Grands Crus vineyards Traditionally, only four grape varieties are allowed for Alsace Grand Cru AOP. Riesling, Pinot Gris, Gewurztraminer, Muscat. *The fifth is now Pinot Noir as of the 2022 vintage. **Crémant d'Alsace AOP:** Traditional method sparkling wine	**Examples of important Alsace Grands Crus Vineyards:** Schlossberg, Brand, Goldert, Hengst **Exceptions to the Alsace Grand Cru AOP grape variety rule:** One of the Grand Crus uses Sylvaner, two of them allow blending, two allow red wine.
Label Terms	Crémant	Edelzwicker, Gentil
Style	**Vendange Tardive (VT):** Late-harvest, rich, full-bodied, not always sweet. **Sélection de Grains Nobles (SGN):** Botrytis-affected grapes, made in small quantities, only in top vintages.	
General Terms		
Classification		
Producers/Proprietary Brand		Trimbach, Domaine Weinbach, Marcel Deiss, Hugel et Fils, Pierre Sparr, Zind-Humbrecht
Vintage		
History & Lore	This region has a history of French and German political rule because it was a strategic area that the two countries fought over for many years. Alsace has a distinctive culture, evident in its architecture, language, and food.	
Service of Beverage		
Food and Beverage Pairing	Wide range of pairings with diversity of wine styles.	Choucroute, Flammkuchen (tarte flambée), Baeckeoffe, and many rich, smoky cured meats such as bacon and sausages.
BOS		Crémant d' Alsace is an alternative, cost-effective source for traditional method sparkling wine.

CERTIFIED SOMMELIER EXAM THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: FRANCE - SOUTH FRANCE ***CERTIFIED SOMMELIER EXAM ONLY***

Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam: After studying this section, a candidate will be able to match regions in the South of France with their grape varieties and styles of wine made.

	Provence	Languedoc-Roussillon	Southwest France	Dordogne
Geography: Location				
	French Mediterranean coastline	Encompasses the entire southern coast of France, from the border of Italy along the Mediterranean coast line to the border with Spain.	South of Bordeaux and North of the Languedoc	Southeast of Bordeaux's Right Bank
	From the border of Italy to the Rhône River.	Languedoc	Spanish Pyrenees border	The Dordogne River
		Roussillon		Flows west from its origin in the Massif Central, runs through the region of Bergerac.
Geography: Climate Categories	Mediterranean	Mediterranean	Continental	Continental
Geography: Physical Features	Mediterranean Sea, rolling foothills	Rolling hillsides, steep cliffs, Mediterranean Sea	Pyrenees Mountains to the south, landlocked	Dordogne River
Soil: Type and/or Name				
Grape Growing		Large amount of IGP wines.		
		Pays d'Oc IGP		
Winemaking	Nearly 90% dry rosé production.	Red, white, rosé, sweet wines, sparkling wines		
		Vins doux naturels are made by the process of **mutage**, a wine-making technique for making sweet wines where fermentation is stopped by the addition of neutral grape spirit.		
Wine: White Grape Variety Names	Clairette, Ugni Blanc (Trebbiano in Italy), Rolle (Vermentino in Italy)	Chardonnay, Sauvignon Blanc, Clairette, Viognier, Muscat, Mauzac, Chenin Blanc	Petit Manseng, Gros Manseng	
Wine: Red Grape Variety Names	Grenache, Cinsault, Syrah, Mourvèdre	Grenache, Syrah, Carignan, Mourvèdre, and Cinsault	Cabernet Sauvignon, Merlot, Cot (Malbec), Tannat	

CERTIFIED SOMMELIER EXAM THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: FRANCE - SOUTH FRANCE ***CERTIFIED SOMMELIER EXAM ONLY***

Wine Law / Appellations: AOPs	Côtes de Provence AOP	LANGUEDOC	Cahors AOP	Bergerac AOP
	Grape Varieties: Cinsault, Grenache, Mourvèdre, Syrah	**Limoux AOP**	**Grape Varieties:** Cot (Malbec)-dominant, additionally Merlot and Tannat	Dordogne River
	Wine Style: Dry rosé-dominant	**White Wines**	**Wine Style:** Dry red wines only	White Wine
	Bandol AOP	**Grape Varieties:** Mauzac, Chenin Blanc, Chardonnay	**Madiran AOP**	**Grape Varieties**: Sémillon, Sauvignon Blanc, Sauvignon Gris, Muscadelle
	Grape Varieties: Mourvèdre (min 50%), Grenache, Cinsault	**Wine Style:** Dry white wines	**Grape Varieties:** Tannat-dominant, additionally Cabernet Franc, Cabernet Sauvignon	**Wine Style:** Dry white wines
	Wine Style: Dry, red wine-dominant	**Red Wines**	**Wine Style:** Dry red wines only	Red and Rosé Wine
		Grape Varieties: Merlot-dominant	**Jurançon AOP**	**Grape Varieties:** Cabernet Sauvignon, Cabernet Franc, Cot (Malbec), Merlot
		Wine Style: Dry red wines	**Grape Varieties:** Gros Manseng and Petit Manseng	**Wine Style:** Dry red and rosé
		Crémant de Limoux AOP	**Wine Style:** White wines	**Monbazillac AOP**
		Grape Varieties: Chardonnay, Chenin Blanc, Mauzac, Pinot Noir	**Blanc Sec:** Dry white wines	Dordogne River
		Wine Style: Traditional method white and rosé sparkling wine.	**Blanc:** Off-dry white wines	White Wine
		Fitou AOP		**Grape Varieties:** Muscadelle, Sauvignon Blanc, Sémillon
		Grape Varieties: Grenache, Carignan, Syrah, Mourvèdre		**Wine Style:** Botrytis-affected sweet wines
		Wine Style: Dry red wines		
		Banyuls AOP/Banyuls Grand Cru AOP		
		Grape Varieties: Grenache		
		Wine Style: Vins Doux Naturels		
		Muscat de Rivesaltes AOP		
		Grape Varieties: Muscat Blanc à Petits Grains, Muscat of Alexandria		
		Wine Style: Vins Doux Naturels		

CERTIFIED SOMMELIER EXAM THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: SOUTH FRANCE

	Côtes de Provence	LANGUEDOC	Cahors AOP	Bergerac AOP
Producer/Proprietary Brand	**Bandol**: Domaine Tempier, Château de Pibarnon, Château Pradeaux	**Banyuls**: Chapoutier, Domaine du Mas Blanc		
Vintage				
History & Lore	Birthplace of wine in France. Has been producing wine since 600 BCE.		Has been growing grapes since 125 BC.	
Food and Beverage Pairing				
	Dry rosé: Shellfish, fish, local fare, bouillabaisse.	**Banyuls:**	**Cahors and Madiran:**	**Monbazillac:**
	Bandol: Beef, lamb	**Sweet:** chocolate, nuts, coffee, creamy desserts, figs, prunes, dried fruit desserts.	Duck breast, rack of lamb, Foie Gras, cassoulet, dishes featuring Périgord truffles.	**Sweet:** Fruit-based desserts, peaches, caramel, citrus, apricots, pears, apple-based desserts.
		Savory: Warm foie gras and figs, savory dishes with elements of sweetness, with fruit or in a sauce.		**Savory:** Foie gras, savory dishes with sweeter sauces.
		Salty blue cheeses		Salty cheeses, creamy cheeses.